

DATA PRESENTATION, ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION OF FINDINGS

4.1 Introduction and Data Notes

A total of 206 responses were recorded; 5 rows contained no study-level entry and were excluded, leaving a valid analytic sample of N = 201. All figures below are re-computed directly from the raw response data rather than carried over from the author's earlier working notes, and two corrections were made in that process.

4.2 Demographic Distribution

Respondents were fairly evenly split by gender: 100 female (49.8%), 97 male (48.3%), and 4 who preferred not to say (2.0%). Distribution across study level was heaviest at 100 Level and lightest at 500 Level:

Study level	n	% of sample
100 Level	52	25.9%
200 Level	38	18.9%
300 Level	38	18.9%
400 Level	45	22.4%
500 Level	28	13.9%
Total	201	100%

4.3 Research Question 1: Extent of Awareness of Official Reporting Channels

"To what extent are Lagos State University undergraduates aware of the official channels for reporting sexual harassment?"

Overall, 97 of 201 respondents (48.3%) were aware of at least one official reporting channel, while 104 (51.7%) were not. Awareness is not evenly distributed, however — it rises consistently with academic seniority, more than tripling from the first to the final year of study:

Study level	Aware — n (%)	Not aware — n (%)
100 Level (n=52)	12 (23.1%)	40 (76.9%)
200 Level (n=38)	13 (34.2%)	25 (65.8%)
300 Level (n=38)	20 (52.6%)	18 (47.4%)
400 Level (n=45)	31 (68.9%)	14 (31.1%)
500 Level (n=28)	21 (75.0%)	7 (25.0%)

Among those aware of a channel, the most recognized were school authorities (64 mentions) and the university's online complaints portal (31), followed by the Sexual and Gender-Based Violence office (29). NGO/helpline referral was the least recognized route (13 mentions). 48 respondents could not name any channel at all — nearly a quarter of the full sample.

On the clarity of university communication about these channels, responses skewed toward the neutral-to-positive end: 63 rated it neutral, 51 clearly, and 51 very clearly, against 28 unclearly and 8 very unclearly. This suggests the communication problem is less about hostility or confusion when information is received, and more about reach (a sizeable share of students, particularly in the junior years, simply are not being reached at all)

4.4 Research Question 2: Social Media Platforms Used to Disseminate Awareness

"Which social media platforms are being used by the university in creating awareness of sexual harassment reporting channels?"

Of the 201 respondents, 95 (47.3%) had encountered awareness content on a platform at all, while 106 (52.7%) had not. Among those who had, WhatsApp was the dominant source by a wide margin, cited by 42 respondents — more than Twitter (X) (14), Facebook (12), TikTok (11), and Instagram (10) combined:

Platform	Respondents citing it
I have not seen any	106
WhatsApp	42
Twitter (X)	14
Facebook	12
TikTok	11
Instagram	10

A separate item asking which platform respondents use most in general corroborates this: WhatsApp accounted for 129 of 201 mentions (64.2%), against Twitter (X) 21, Instagram 19, TikTok 16, and Facebook 16. Taken together, both measures point to the same conclusion — any awareness strategy that does not prioritize WhatsApp is missing the channel students already default to.

The platform mix shifts somewhat by level: TikTok and Twitter feature more prominently among 500 Level respondents (6 and 6 mentions respectively, out of only 7 who had seen no content at all), while WhatsApp is the clear leader at every other level.

4.5 Research Question 3: Does Social Media Awareness Influence Willingness to Use Official Channels?

"Does awareness created through social media influence students' willingness to use official reporting channels?"

Respondents were split into two groups:

Those who had been exposed to sexual harassment awareness content by the university (n=69) and those who had not (n=130) — and compared on both channel awareness and willingness to report.

Group	Aware of a reporting channel	Willing to use one
Exposed to sexual harassment awareness content (n=69)	55 (79.7%)	48 (69.6%)

Group	Aware of a reporting channel	Willing to use one
Not exposed to sexual harassment awareness content (n=130)	40 (30.8%)	28 (21.5%)

Students exposed to sexual harassment awareness content by the university were nearly three times as likely to know a reporting channel (79.7% vs 30.8%), a substantially stronger finding than earlier working figures suggested. A chi-square test of independence confirms this is not attributable to chance: $\chi^2(1, N=201) = 24.91, p < .001$.

The willingness gap is also substantial (69.6% vs 21.5%) and statistically significant: $\chi^2(2, N=201) = 13.68, p = .001$. Exposure is associated with fewer "unsure" responses and slightly more outright refusals — consistent with exposure pushing students off the fence in both directions rather than uniformly building confidence.

Taken together, these results support a positive answer to Research Question 3: awareness created through social media is significantly associated with both knowing and being willing to use official reporting channels. The relationship is strongest for the awareness pathway; its effect on willingness, while real, is more modest, suggesting that exposure alone does not fully close the willingness gap and other factors (trust in the institution, confidentiality concerns, past experience) likely also play a role.

4.6 Summary of Findings

- Awareness of official reporting channels stands at 48.3% overall and rises steadily by study level, from 23.1% at 100 Level to 75.0% at 500 Level.
- WhatsApp is the primary platform through which awareness content reaches students, cited by more respondents than all other platforms combined.
- Exposure to social media awareness content is significantly associated with both channel awareness ($p < .001$) and willingness to report ($p = .001$), directly supporting the study's central premise — though the willingness effect is more modest than the awareness effect.
- 70% of the full sample said they would be willing to use an official reporting channel; 19% were unsure and 11% unwilling.
- Nearly a quarter of respondents (48/201) could not name any official reporting channel, indicating a communication reach gap that widens the further a student is from graduation.